11.4 The Business Architecture Perspective

The Business Architecture Perspective highlights the unique characteristics of business analysis when practiced in the context of business architecture.

Business architecture models the enterprise in order to show how strategic concerns of key stakeholders are met and to support ongoing business transformation efforts.

Business architecture provides architectural descriptions and views, referred to as blueprints, to provide a common understanding of the organization for the purpose of aligning strategic objectives with tactical demands. The discipline of business architecture applies analytical thinking and architectural principles to the enterprise level. The solutions may include changes in the business model, operating model, organizational structure, or drive other initiatives.

Business architecture follows certain fundamental architectural principles:

- **Scope**: the scope of business architecture is the entire enterprise. It is not a single project, initiative, process, or piece of information. It puts projects, processes, and information into the larger business context to provide an understanding of interactions, integration opportunities, redundancies, and inconsistencies.
- **Separation of concerns**: business architecture separates concerns within its context. It specifically separates what the business does from:
  - the information the business uses,
  - how the business is performed,
  - who does it and where in the enterprise it is done,
  - when it is done,
  - why it is done, and
  - how well it is done.

  Once the independent concerns are identified, they can be grouped in specific combinations or mappings, which can be used to analyze targeted business issues.
- **Scenario driven**: there are many different questions that a business tries to answer to provide the blueprint for alignment. Each of these different questions or business scenarios requires a different set of blueprints containing a different set of information and relationships, with different types of outcomes and measures to determine success.
- **Knowledge based**: while the primary goal of business architecture is to answer these business questions, a secondary but important goal is to collect and catalogue the different architectural components (what, how, who, why, etc.) and their relationships in a knowledge base so they can quickly and easily be used to help answer the next business question that comes up. The knowledge base is often managed in a formal architectural repository.

11.4.1 Change Scope

.1 Breadth of Change

Business architecture may be performed:

- across the enterprise as a whole,
- across a single line of business within the enterprise (defining the architecture of one of the enterprise's business models), or
- across a single functional division.

Business architecture activities are generally performed with a view of the entire enterprise in mind, but may also be performed for an autonomous business unit within the enterprise. A broad scope is required to manage consistency and integration at the enterprise level. For example, business architecture can clarify a situation where the same business capability is implemented by multiple different processes and multiple different organizations using different information models. Given the clarity that comes from an enterprise scope, the business can then determine if this structure is the best way to align with strategic objectives.

.2 Depth of Change

A business architecture effort may focus on the executive level of the enterprise to support strategic decision making, or on the management level to support the execution of initiatives.

While business architecture provides important context, it does not usually operate at the operational decision or process level; instead, it assesses processes at the level of the value stream.

.3 Value and Solutions Delivered

Business architecture, using the principle of separation of concerns, develops models that decompose the business system, solution, or organization into individual elements with specific functions and shows the interactions between them.

The elements of business architecture models include:

- capabilities,
- value,
- processes,
- information and data,
- organization,
- reporting and management,
- stakeholders,
- security strategies, and
- outcomes.

Architecture models enable organizations to see the big picture of the domain that is under analysis. They provide insights into the important elements of the organization or software system and how they fit together, and highlight the critical components or capabilities.

The insights provided by business architecture help keep systems and operations functioning in a coherent and useful manner, and add clarity to business decisions. When change is being considered, the architecture provides details on the elements that are most relevant for the purposes of the change, allowing for prioritization and resource allocation. Because an architectural model also shows how the parts are related, it can be used to provide impact analysis to tell what other elements of the system or the business might be affected by the change.

The architecture itself can be used as a tool to help identify needed changes. The performance metrics for each element of the architecture can be monitored and assessed to identify when an element is under-performing. The importance of each element can be compared with the performance of the organization or system as a whole. This assists decision makers when considering where investment is needed and how to prioritize those decisions.

The function of business architecture is to facilitate coordinated and synchronized action across the organization by aligning action with the organization's vision, goals, and strategy. The architectural models created in this process are the tools used to clarify, unify, and provide understanding of the intent of the vision, goals, and strategy, and to ensure that resources are focused and applied to the elements of the organization that align with and support this direction.

Business architecture provides a blueprint that management can use to plan and execute strategies from both information technology (IT) and non-IT perspectives. Business architecture is used by organizations to guide:

- strategic planning,
- business remodelling,
- organization redesign,
- performance measurement and other transformation initiatives to improve customer retention,
- streamlining business operations,
- cost reduction,
- the formalization of institutional knowledge, and
- the creation of a vehicle for businesses to communicate and deploy their business vision.

.4 Delivery Approach

Business architecture creates a planning framework that provides clarity and insight into the organization and assists decision makers in identifying required changes. The architectural blueprints provided by business architecture provide an insight and understanding of how well the organization aligns to its strategy. This insight is the trigger for change or other planning activities.

For each blueprint provided, business architecture may define:

- current state,
- future state, and
- one or more transition states that are used to transition to the future state.

Business architects require a view of the entire organization. In general, they may report directly to a member of senior leadership. Business architects require a broad understanding of the organization, including its:

- environment and industry trends,
- structure and reporting relationships,
- value streams,
- capabilities,
- processes,
- information and data stores, and
- how all these elements align to support the strategy of the organization.

Business architects play an important role in communicating and innovating for the strategy of the organization. They utilize blueprints, models, and insights provided by business architecture to continually advocate for the strategy of the organization and address individual stakeholder needs within the scope of the organization's goals.

There are several factors central to a successful business architecture:

- support of the executive business leadership team,
- integration with clear and effective governance processes, including organizational decision-making authorities (for example, for investments, initiatives, and infrastructure decisions),
- integration with ongoing initiatives, (this might include participation in steering committees or other similar advisory groups), and
- access to senior leadership, departmental managers, product owners, solution architects, project business analysts, and project managers.

.5 Major Assumptions

To make business architecture useful to the organization, business analysts require:

- a view of the entire organization that is under analysis,
- full support from the senior leadership,
- participation of business owners and subject matter experts (SMEs),
- an organizational strategy to be in place, and
- a business imperative to be addressed.

11.4.2 Business Analysis Scope

.1 Change Sponsor

Ideally, the sponsor of a business architecture initiative is a senior executive or business owner within the organization. However, the sponsor may also be a line-of-business owner.

.2 Change Targets

The following list identifies the possible primary change targets resulting from a business architecture analysis:

- business capabilities,
- business value streams,
- initiative plans,
- investment decisions, and
- portfolio decisions.

The following groups of people use business architecture to guide change within the organization:

- management at all levels of the organization,
- product or service owners,
- operational units,
- solution architects,
- project managers, and
- business analysts working in other contexts (for example, at the project level).

.3 Business Analyst Position

The goal of a business analyst working within the discipline of business architecture is to:

- understand the entire enterprise context and provide balanced insight into all the elements and their relationship across the enterprise, and
- provide a holistic, understandable view of all the specialties within the organization.

Business architecture provides a variety of models of the organization. These models, or blueprints, provide holistic insight into the organization that becomes the basis for strategic decisions by the leaders of the organization. To develop a business architecture, the business analyst must understand, assimilate, and align a wide variety of specialties that are of strategic concern to the organization. To do this they require insight, skills, and knowledge from:

- business strategy and goals,
- conceptual business information,
- enterprise IT architecture,
- process architecture, and
- business performance and intelligence architecture.

Business architecture supports the strategic advisory and planning groups that guide and make decisions regarding change within the organization. It provides guidance and insights into how decisions align to the strategic goals of the organization, and ensures this alignment throughout the various transition states as the change moves towards its future state.

.4 Business Analysis Outcomes

Business architecture provides a broad scope and a holistic view for business analysis.

The general outcomes of business architecture include:

- the alignment of the organization to its strategy,
- the planning of change in the execution of strategy, and
- ensuring that as change is implemented, it continues to align to the strategy.

These business architecture outcomes provide context for requirements analysis, planning and prioritization, estimation, and high-level system design. This provides insight and alignment with strategy, stakeholder needs, and business capabilities. Architectural views and blueprints provide information that may have otherwise been based on assumptions, and minimize the risk of duplication of efforts in creating capabilities, systems, or information that already exist elsewhere in the enterprise.

The various models and blueprints provided by business architecture are its key deliverables. These include, but are not limited to:

- business capability maps,
- value stream maps,
- organization maps,
- business information concepts,
- high-level process architecture, and
- business motivation models.

11.4.3 Reference Models and Techniques

.1 Reference Models

Reference models are predefined architectural templates that provide one or more viewpoints for a particular industry or function that is commonly found across multiple sectors (for example, IT or finance).

Reference models are frequently considered the default architecture ontology for the industry or function. They provide a baseline architecture starting point that business architects can adapt to meet the needs of their organization.

The follow table lists some of the common reference models.

Table 11.4.1: Business Architecture Reference Models

Reference Model	Domain
Association for Cooperative Operations Research and Development (ACORD)	Insurance and Financial industries
Business Motivation Model (BMM)	Generic
Control Objectives for IT (COBIT)	IT governance and management
eTOM and FRAMEWORX	Communications sector
Federal Enterprise Architecture Service Reference Model (FEA SRM)	Government (developed for the U.S. Federal Government)
Information Technology Infrastructure Library (ITIL®)	IT service management
Process Classification Framework (PCF)	Multiple sectors including aerospace, defence, automotive, education, electric utilities, petroleum, pharmaceutical, and telecommunications
Supply Chain Operations Reference (SCOR)	Supply chain management
Value Reference Model (VRM)	Value change and network management

.2 Techniques

The following table lists techniques that are commonly used within the discipline of business architecture, and are not included in the Techniques section of the *BABOK® Guide*.

Table 11.4.2: Business Architecture Techniques

Technique	Description
Archimate®	An open standard modelling language.
Business Motivation Model (BMM)	A formalization of the business motivation in terms of mission, vision, strategies, tactics, goals, objectives, policies, rules, and influencers.
Business Process Architecture	The modelling of the processes, including interface points, as a means of providing a holistic view of the processes that exist within an organization.
Capability Map	A hierarchical catalogue of business capabilities, or what the business does. Capabilities are categorized according to strategic, core, and supporting.
Customer Journey Map	A model that depicts the journey of a customer through various touch points and the various stakeholders within the service or organization. Customer journey maps are frequently used to analyze or design the user experience from multiple perspectives.
Enterprise Core Diagram	Models the integration and standardizations of the organization.
Information Map	A catalogue of the important business concepts (fundamental business entities) associated with the business capabilities and value delivery. This is typically developed in conjunction with the capability model and represents the common business vocabulary for the enterprise. It is not a data model but rather a taxonomy of the business.
Organizational Map	A model that shows the relationship of business units to each other, to external partners, and to capabilities and information. Unlike a typical organizational chart the map is focused on the interaction between units, not the structural hierarchy.
Project Portfolio Analysis	Used to model programs, projects, and portfolios to provide a holistic view of the initiatives of the organization.
Roadmap	Models the actions, dependencies, and responsibilities required for the organization to move from current state, through the transition states, to the future state.
Service-Oriented Analysis	Used to model analysis, design, and architecture of systems and software to provide a holistic view of the IT infrastructure of the organization.

Table 11.4.2: Business Architecture Techniques (Continued)

Technique	Description
The Open Group Architecture Framework (TOGAF®)	Provides a method for developing enterprise architecture. Phase B of the TOGAF Architecture Development Method (ADM) is focused on the development of business architecture. Organizations following TOGAF may choose to tailor Phase B to adopt the business architecture blueprints, techniques, and references described in the *BABOK® Guide*.
Value Mapping	Value mapping provides a holistic representation of the stream of activities required to deliver value. It is used to identify areas of potential improvement in an end–to–end process. Although there are several different types of value mapping, a value stream is often used in business architecture.
Zachman Framework	Provides an ontology of enterprise primitive concepts based on a matrix of six interrogatives (what, how, where, who, when, why) and six levels of abstraction (executive, business management, architect, engineer, technician, enterprise). Business architects may find that exploring the executive or business management perspectives across the different interrogatives provides clarity and insight.

11.4.4 Underlying Competencies

In addition to the underlying competencies, business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture require:

- a high tolerance for ambiguity and uncertainty,
- the ability to put things into a broader context,
- the ability to transform requirements and context into a concept or design of a solution.
- the ability to suppress unnecessary detail to provide higher level views,
- the ability to think in long time frames over multiple years,
- the ability to deliver tactical outcomes (short term), which simultaneously provide immediate value and contribute to achieving the business strategy (long term),
- the ability to interact with people at the executive level,
- the ability to consider multiple scenarios or outcomes,
- the ability to lead and direct change in organizations, and
- a great deal of political acumen.

11.4.5 Impact on Knowledge Areas

This section explains how specific business analysis practices within business architecture are mapped to business analysis tasks and practices as defined by the *BABOK® Guide*. This section describes how each knowledge area is applied or modified within the business architecture discipline.

Each knowledge area lists techniques relevant to a business architecture perspective. *BABOK® Guide* techniques are found in the Techniques chapter of the *BABOK® Guide*. Other business analysis techniques are not found in the Techniques chapter of the *BABOK® Guide* but are considered to be particularly useful to business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture. This is not intended to be an exhaustive list of techniques but rather to highlight the types of techniques used by business analysts while performing the tasks within the knowledge area.

.1 Business Analysis Planning and Monitoring

During Business Analysis Planning and Monitoring, the discipline of business architecture requires business analysts to understand the organization's:

- strategy and direction,
- operating model and value proposition,
- current business and operational capabilities,
- stakeholders and their points of engagement,
- plans for growth, governance, and planning processes,
- culture and environment, and
- capacity for change.

Once these elements are understood the business analyst can then develop an understanding of which architectural viewpoints are relevant to the analysis.

Governance planning and monitoring activities primarily focus on:

- selecting which projects or initiatives will provide the most benefit in achieving the business strategies and outcomes, and
- determining which frameworks or models exist or are utilized within the organization.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Acceptance and Evaluation Criteria (p. 217)
- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Business Capability Analysis (p. 230)
- Decision Analysis (p. 261)
- Estimation (p. 271)
- Functional Decomposition (p. 283)
- Interviews (p. 290)
- Item Tracking (p. 294)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)

- Non-Functional Requirements Analysis (p. 302)
- Organizational Modelling (p. 308)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Reviews (p. 326)
- Risk Analysis and Management (p. 329)
- Roles and Permissions Matrix (p. 333)
- Root Cause Analysis (p. 335)
- Scope Modelling (p. 338)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- Use Cases and Scenarios (p. 356)
- User Stories (p. 359)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Business Process Architecture
- Capability Map
- Project Portfolio Analysis
- Service-oriented Analysis

.2 Elicitation and Collaboration

Business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture typically deal with a great deal of ambiguity and uncertainty. When undertaking Elicitation and Collaboration tasks, business analysts consider changes in organizational direction based on external and internal forces and changes in marketplace environment. The types of changes can frequently be predicted, but external market pressures frequently make the pace of the change unpredictable.

As business architecture requires many inputs from across the organization, access to (and the availability of) stakeholders is critical to success. Business analysts elicit inputs such as strategy, value, existing architectures, and performance metrics.

Advocacy for the organization's strategy is central to the communication strategy of business architects. As members of various steering committees and advisory groups, business architects utilize formal communication channels within projects, initiatives, and operational groups to communicate the organization's strategy, explain the organizational context, and advocate alignment with the strategy.

Ensuring stakeholders understand and support the organization's strategy is an essential function within the discipline of business architecture. Business architects may impose scope and constraints on a project or initiative as a means to ensure the activity aligns to the organization's strategy, which may be viewed unfavourably. It is the role of the business architect to bridge the needs and desires of individual stakeholders, projects, and operational groups with the context and understanding of the organizational goals and strategy. The business architect's goal is to optimize the enterprise's goals and strategy, and discourage activities that achieve a narrow goal at the cost of sub-optimizing the entire objective. This is an exercise in both elicitation and in collaboration.

The business architect acquires a deep understanding of the strategy, drivers, motivations, and aspirations of the organization and those of the stakeholders. Once this level of understanding is achieved, the business architect collaborates with all levels of the organization including senior leadership, managers, the project management office (PMO), product owners, project managers, various business analysts, solution architects, and IT personnel to bridge gaps in understanding and communicating the importance of alignment with organizational strategy. Facilitating effective collaboration requires that the business architect is able to understand the wide variety of perspectives and contexts from which each stakeholder operates. The business architect must also be able to communicate with each of these stakeholders in a language that is mutually understood and supported.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Document Analysis (p. 269)
- Focus Groups (p. 279)
- Functional Decomposition (p. 283)
- Glossary (p. 286)
- Interface Analysis (p. 287)
- Interviews (p. 290)
- Item Tracking (p. 294)
- Observation (p. 305)
- Prototyping (p. 323)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- none

.3 Requirements Life Cycle Management

It is essential that business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture have executive support and agreement of the work to be undertaken. An architecture review board comprised of senior executives with decision-making powers can review and assess changes to the business architecture. This group will often also engage in portfolio management by making decisions regarding the investment in and prioritization of change based on their impact to business outcomes and strategy.

Business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture understand how projects impact the business architecture on an ongoing basis and work to continually expand, correct, or improve the business architecture. They also identify possible emerging changes in both internal and external situations (including market conditions), and decide on how to incorporate these changes into the business architecture of the organization.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Balanced Scorecard (p. 223)
- Benchmarking and Market Analysis (p. 226)
- Business Capability Analysis (p. 230)
- Collaborative Games (p. 243)
- Data Modelling (p. 256)
- Decision Analysis (p. 261)
- Estimation (p. 271)

- Interface Analysis (p. 287)
- Item Tracking (p. 294)
- Lessons Learned (p. 296)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Organizational Modelling (p. 308)
- Process Analysis (p. 314)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Reviews (p. 326)
- Risk Analysis and Management (p. 329)
- Roles and Permissions Matrix (p. 333)
- Root Cause Analysis (p. 335)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- SWOT Analysis (p. 353)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Archimate®
- Business Process Architecture
- Business Value Modelling
- Capability Map
- Enterprise Core Diagram
- Project Portfolio Analysis
- Roadmap
- Service-oriented Analysis
- Value Mapping

.4 Strategy Analysis

Business architecture can play a significant role in strategy analysis. It provides architectural views into the current state of the organization and helps to define both the future state and the transition states required to achieve the future state.

Business architects develop roadmaps based on the organization's change strategy. Clearly defined transition states help ensure that the organization continues to deliver value and remain competitive throughout all the phases of the change. To keep competitive, the business must analyze such factors as:

- market conditions,
- which markets to move into,
- how the organization will compete in the transition state, and
- how to best position the organization's brand proposition.

Business architecture provides the enterprise context and architectural views that allow an understanding of the enterprise so these questions can be analyzed in the context of cost, opportunity, and effort.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Balanced Scorecard (p. 223)
- Benchmarking and Market Analysis (p. 226)
- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Business Capability Analysis (p. 230)
- Business Model Canvas (p. 236)
- Business Rules Analysis (p. 240)
- Collaborative Games (p. 243)
- Data Modelling (p. 256)
- Document Analysis (p. 269)
- Estimation (p. 271)
- Focus Groups (p. 279)

- Glossary (p. 286)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Organizational Modelling (p. 308)
- Reviews (p. 326)
- Risk Analysis and Management (p. 329)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- SWOT Analysis (p. 353)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Archimate®
- Business Process Architecture
- Capability Map
- Customer Journey Map
- Enterprise Core Diagram
- Project Portfolio Analysis
- Roadmap
- Service-oriented Analysis
- Strategy Map
- Value Mapping

.5 Requirements Analysis and Design Definition

Business architecture provides individual architectural views into the organization through a variety of models that are selected for the stakeholders utilizing the view. These architectural views can be provided by capability and value maps, organizational maps, and information and business process models. Business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture employ expertise, judgment, and experience when deciding what is (and what is not) important to model. Models are intended to provide context and information that result in better requirements analysis and design.

The architectural context and the ability to reference readily available architectural views provides information that would have otherwise been based on assumptions that the analyst must make because no other information was available. By providing this information, business architecture minimizes the risk of duplication of efforts in creating capabilities, systems, or information that already exist elsewhere in the enterprise.

Design is done in conjunction with understanding needs and requirements. Business architecture provides the context to analyze the strategic alignment of proposed changes and the effects those changes have upon each other. Business architects synthesize knowledge and insights from multiple architectural views to determine if proposed changes work towards or conflict with the organization's goals.

Business architecture attempts to ensure that the enterprise as a whole continues to deliver value to stakeholders both during normal operations and during change. Business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture focus on the value provided by the organization from a holistic view. They attempt to avoid local optimization where effort and resources are put into a single process or system improvement which does not align with the strategy and garners no meaningful impact to the enterprise as a whole—or worse, sub-optimizes the whole.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Acceptance and Evaluation Criteria (p. 217)
- Backlog Management (p. 220)
- Balanced Scorecard (p. 223)
- Benchmarking and Market Analysis (p. 226)
- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Business Capability Analysis (p. 230)
- Business Model Canvas (p. 236)
- Business Rules Analysis (p. 240)
- Collaborative Games (p. 243)
- Data Dictionary (p. 247)
- Data Flow Diagrams (p. 250)
- Data Modelling (p. 256)
- Decision Analysis (p. 261)
- Document Analysis (p. 269)
- Estimation (p. 271)
- Focus Groups (p. 279)
- Functional Decomposition (p. 283)
- Glossary (p. 286)
- Interface Analysis (p. 287)
- Item Tracking (p. 294)
- Lessons Learned (p. 296)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Non-Functional Requirements Analysis (p. 302)
- Observation (p. 305)
- Organizational Modelling (p. 308)
- Process Analysis (p. 314)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
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- Risk Analysis and Management (p. 329)
- Roles and Permissions Matrix (p. 333)
- Root Cause Analysis (p. 335)
- Scope Modelling (p. 338)
- Sequence Diagrams (p. 341)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- State Modelling (p. 348)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- SWOT Analysis (p. 353)
- Use Cases and Scenarios (p. 356)
- User Stories (p. 359)
- Vendor Assessment (p. 361)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Archimate®
- Business Process Architecture
- Capability Map
- Customer Journey Map
- Enterprise Core Diagram
- Project Portfolio Analysis
- Roadmap
- Service-oriented Analysis
- Value Mapping

.6 Solution Evaluation

Business architecture asks fundamental questions about the business, including the important question of how well the business is performing.

To answer this question, several other questions must be answered:

- What outcomes are the business, a particular initiative, or component expecting to achieve?
- How can those outcomes be measured in terms of SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bounded) objectives?
- What information is needed to measure those objectives?
- How do processes, services, initiatives, etc. need to be instrumented to collect that information?
- How is the performance information best presented in terms of reports, ad hoc queries, dashboards, etc.?
- How do we use this information to make investment decisions in the future?

For example, at a more detailed level, an important part of capability definition and process architecture is to identify the specific performance characteristics and outcome that those capabilities or processes are expected to achieve. The actual measurement is rarely conducted by business analysts. It is usually done by business owners, operational, or information technology managers.

Business analysts working in the discipline of business architecture analyze the results of measurements and factor these results into subsequent planning.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Balanced Scorecard (p. 223)
- Benchmarking and Market Analysis (p. 226)
- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Business Capability Analysis (p. 230)
- Collaborative Games (p. 243)
- Focus Groups (p. 279)
- Item Tracking (p. 294)
- Lessons Learned (p. 296)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Observation (p. 305)
- Organizational Modelling (p. 308)
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- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Risk Analysis and Management (p. 329)
- Roles and Permissions Matrix (p. 333)
- Root Cause Analysis (p. 335)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- SWOT Analysis (p. 353)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Business Motivation Modelling
- Business Process Architecture
- Capability Map
- Customer Journey Map
- Service-oriented Analysis
- Value Mapping

11.5 The Business Process Management Perspective

The Business Process Management Perspective highlights the unique characteristics of business analysis when practiced in the context of developing or improving business processes.

Business Process Management (BPM) is a management discipline and a set of enabling technologies that:

- focuses on how the organization performs work to deliver value across multiple functional areas to customers and stakeholders,
- aims for a view of value delivery that spans the entire organization, and
- views the organization through a process-centric lens.

A BPM initiative delivers value by implementing improvements to the way work is performed in an organization.

BPM determines how manual and automated processes are created, modified, cancelled, and governed. Organizations that hold a process-centric view treat BPM as an ongoing effort and an integral part of the ongoing management and operation of the organization.

11.5.1 Change Scope

Business analysts working within the BPM discipline may address a single process with limited scope or they may address all of the processes in the organization. Business analysts frequently focus on how the processes of an organization can be changed in order to improve and meet the objectives of the organization.

BPM life cycles generally include the following activities:

- **Designing**: the identification of processes and definition of their current state (as-is) and determining how we get to the future state (to-be). The gap between these states may be used to specify stakeholders' expectations of how the business should be run.
- **Modelling**: the graphical representation of the process that documents the process as well as comparing current state (as-is) and future state (to-be). This phase of the BPM life cycle provides input to requirements and solution design specification, as well as analyzing their potential value. Simulation may use quantitative data so that the potential value of variations on the process can be analyzed and compared.
- **Execution and Monitoring**: provides the same type of input as modelling but in terms of the actual execution of processes. The data collected as a result of the actual business process flow is very reliable and objective which makes it a very strong asset in analyzing value and recommending alternatives for design improvement.
- **Optimizing**: the act of ongoing repetition or iteration of the previous phases. The results of business process execution and monitoring are utilized to modify models and designs so that all inefficiencies are removed

and more value is added. Optimization may be a source of requirements and solution design definitions that comes directly from stakeholders and the user community. Optimization of processes is also a good way to demonstrate the value of a suggested solution modification, and justify process and product improvement initiatives.

.1 Breadth of Change

The goal of BPM is to ensure that value delivery is optimized across end-to-end processes. A comprehensive BPM initiative can span the entire enterprise. A single BPM initiative can make an organization become more process-centric by providing insights into its processes. An organization's processes define what the organization does and how it does it. Possessing a thorough understanding of its processes allows stakeholders to adjust these processes to meet the evolving needs of both the organization and its customers.

Individual initiatives may improve specific processes and sub-processes. Breaking down larger, more complex processes into smaller chunks (sub-processes) allows business analysts to better understand what each process is doing and how to optimize them.

.2 Depth of Change

Business analysts use BPM frameworks to facilitate the analysis and deep understanding of the organization's processes. BPM frameworks are sets or descriptions of processes for a generic organization, specific industry, professional area, or type of value stream. BPM frameworks define particular levels of processes throughout the organization's process architecture.

As an example, business analysts perform supply chain analysis as a means of evaluating specific processes in an organization. Analysis of the supply chain is frequently conducted by decomposing group-level processes into individual sub-components and then decomposing these down to individuals performing specific tasks.

Business analysts involved with business process management are frequently engaged in continuous improvement activities as they are often the ones most familiar with BPM.

.3 Value and Solutions Delivered

The goal of BPM is to improve operational performance (effectiveness, efficiency, adaptability, and quality) and to reduce costs and risks. Business analysts frequently consider transparency into processes and operations as a common core value of BPM initiatives. Transparency into processes and operations provides decision makers a clear view of the operational consequences of previous process related decisions. Business analysis efforts frequently begin with the identification of the business need of the customers. Needs are generally referred to as BPM drivers. BPM drivers include:

- cost reduction initiatives,
- increase in quality,

- increase in productivity,
- emerging competition,
- risk management,
- compliance initiatives,
- next generation process automation,
- core system implementation,
- innovation and growth,
- post merger and acquisition rationalization,
- standardization initiatives,
- major transformation programs,
- establishment of a BPM Centre of Excellence,
- increased agility, and
- speed or faster processes.

.4 Delivery Approach

The delivery approach for BPM initiatives across organizations ranges from a set of tactical methods focused on improving individual processes to a management discipline that touches all the processes in an organization. The main purpose of process transformation is to help organizations identify, prioritize, and optimize their business processes to deliver value to stakeholders.

Organizations conduct periodic assessments of key processes and engage in ongoing continuous improvement to achieve and sustain process excellence. The success of BPM can be measured by how well the BPM initiative aligns to the objectives set for BPM in the organization.

There are several mechanisms that can be used to implement BPM:

- **Business process re-engineering**: methods that aim for major process redesign across the enterprise.
- **Evolutionary forms of change**: methods that have overall objectives set for the process and then individual changes aimed at bringing sub-processes in line with those goals are implemented.
- **Substantial discovery**: methods are used when organizational processes are undefined or if the documented version of the process is substantially different from the actual process in use. Substantial discovery is about revealing actual processes and is a method for organizational analysis.
- **Process benchmarking**: compares an organization's business processes and performance metrics to industry best practices. Dimensions typically measured are quality, time, and cost.
- **Specialized BPMS applications**: are designed to support BPM initiatives and execute the process models directly. These applications are tools that

automate BPM activities. Often the organization's processes are required to be changed to match the automated approach.

Process improvement approaches can be categorized in terms of their point of origin and whether their solutions are primarily organizational (people-based) or technological (IT-based). Organizations can better understand the process improvement methodology, as mentioned in the previous paragraph, to apply based on the following organizing principles:

- **Top-down**: initiatives are typically orchestrated from a central point of control by senior management and have organization spanning implications, targeted at end-to-end processes or major parts of the business.
- **Bottom-up**: initiatives are typically tactical approaches to improving individual processes and departmental workflows, or sub-processes in smaller parts of the organization.
- **People-centric**: initiatives where the principal change is to the activities and workflows in an organization.
- **IT-centric**: initiatives frequently focused on process automation.

.5 Major Assumptions

The following is a list of major assumptions from the BPM discipline:

- Processes are generally supported by information technology systems, but the development of those systems is not covered by most BPM methods. Business analysts may suggest additional business requirements based on existing IT systems.
- BPM initiatives have senior management support. The business analyst may be involved in suggesting additional business requirements based on organizational strategies.
- BPM systems require a tight integration with organizational strategy but most methods do not tackle the development of strategy which is outside the scope of this perspective.
- BPM initiatives are cross-functional and end-to-end in the organization.

11.5.2 Business Analysis Scope

.1 Change Sponsor

Enterprise-wide BPM initiatives are typically started by executives focusing on value and outcomes and then linking these strategic objectives to the corresponding business processes which most closely support the objectives.

BPM initiatives are frequently triggered by an external situation which generates a business need. Enterprise business analysis practices are applied to develop a business case for a BPM initiative.

Process improvements are typically initiated or at least managed by a process manager at any level of the organization. The scope of the process or sub-process usually determines the authority of the process manager.

.2 Change Targets

The possible primary change targets for a BPM initiative include:

- **Customer**: the key stakeholder in any BPM initiative. The principal focus is on the external customer but internal customers are also considered. Since BPM is customer-centric by nature, the customer is part of BPM initiatives in order to validate the effectiveness of the process change. Involving the customer early in the initiative minimizes the risk of failure by ensuring the goals of process delivery are aligned to the customer's expectations.
- **Regulator**: a stakeholder in any BPM initiative due to evolving requirements towards compliance and risk management by some organizations. Regulators may trigger a BPM initiative due to changes in regulations on such concerns as public safety, transparency, equal opportunity, and non-discrimination.
- **Process Owner**: the key stakeholder in any BPM initiative and has the responsibility and authority to make the final decision regarding any changes to the affected processes. The process owner is also responsible for measuring the process performance.
- **Process Participants**: stakeholders who directly or indirectly participate in the process being evaluated. These participants define the activities of the process. In order to ensure that the interests of process participants are met, the process owner engages them during design of the process.
- **Project Manager**: manages the BPM initiative and is accountable for its delivery and driving decisions. The project manager works with a team including process analysts, process owners, and process designers. The project manager is responsible for planning, scheduling, communication management, change management, and risk management.
- **Implementation Team**: converts the plans of the BPM initiative into functioning business processes. The success of a BPM initiative is the ability to integrate all the functions that meet the needs of the customer.

.3 Business Analysis Position

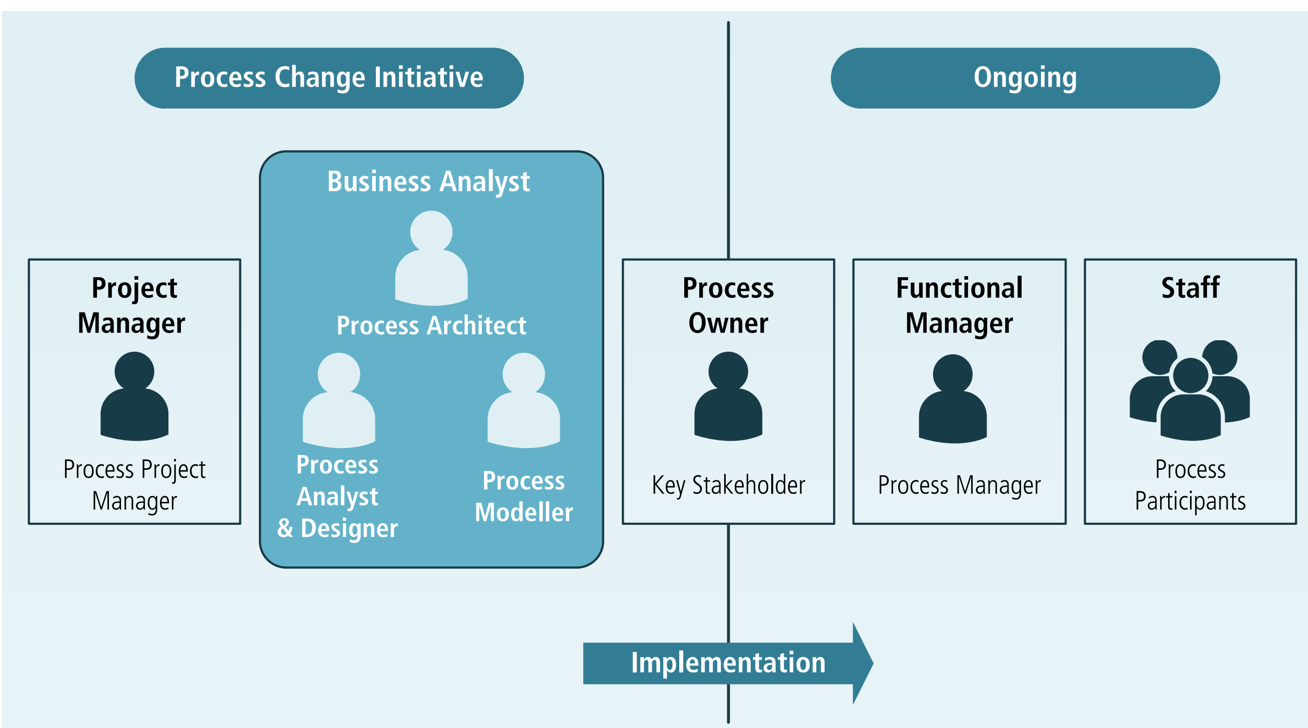
Business analysts working within the discipline of business process management may assume a variety of roles:

- **Process Architect**: responsible for modelling, analyzing, deploying, monitoring, and continuously improving business processes. A process architect knows how to design business processes and how to enhance those processes either manually or for automated business process execution on a BPM platform. Process architects address and guide the decisions around what process knowledge, methodology, and technology is required to meet the objectives of the organization with respect to a particular BPM initiative. Process architects enhance and transform business processes into technically enhanced and executable process templates. Depending on the BPM initiative, process architects may be focused on managing business performance or on mapping technology to business operations. Process architects are responsible for developing and maintaining standards and the repository of reference models for products and services, business processes, key performance indicators (KPIs), and critical success factors (CSF). They are engaged in process analysis and transformation initiatives.

- **Process Analyst/Designer**: has detailed process knowledge, skills, and interest. They are experts in documenting and understanding process design along with performance trends. Process analysts/designers have an interest in business process optimization to increase overall business performance. This goal requires an understanding of the detailed process and includes performing the necessary analysis for process optimization. They perform analysis and assessment of as-is processes, evaluate alternate process design options, and make recommendations for change based on various frameworks.
- **Process Modeller**: captures and documents business (both the as-is and to-be) processes. The process modeller is frequently a process analyst working to document a process for implementation or support by an information technology system.

The process analyst/designer and the process modeller functions frequently reside within a single position.

Figure 11.5.1: Business Analyst Roles in a BPM Initiative



.4 Business Analysis Outcomes

Outcomes for business analysts working within the discipline of business process management include:

- business process models,
- business rules,
- process performance measures,
- business decisions, and
- process performance assessment.

Business Process Models

Business process models start at the highest level as an end-to-end model of the whole process and can become as specific as modelling specific work flow. Business process models serve as both an output and a starting point for the analysis of the process. They are divided into current state (as-is) and future state (to-be) models. Current state models portray the process as it currently functions, without any improvements. The future state model envisions what the process would look like if all improvement options are incorporated. The benefit of developing the current state model is to justify the investment in the process by enabling the business analyst to measure the effect of the process improvements and prioritize changes to the process. Transition models describe the interim states required to move from the current state process to the future state process.

Business Rules

Business rules guide business processes and are intended to assert business structure or control the behaviour of business. Business rules are identified during requirements elicitation and process analysis and often focus on business calculations, access control issues, and policies of an organization. Classifying business rules can help decide how they will be best implemented. Business rules analysis provides insight into how the business functions and how the processes contribute to meeting the business' goals and objectives. Business analysts analyze the reasons for the existence of a business rule and study its impact on the business process before improving or redesigning it. Business rules may, where appropriate, be mapped to individual processes through the decisions they influence unless they are related strictly to the performance of the process.

Process Performance Measures

Process performance measures are parameters that are used to identify process improvement opportunities. Process performance measures are defined and deployed to ensure that processes are aligned to the business needs and strategic objectives of the organization. Process performance measures can address many aspects of a process including quality, time, cost, agility, efficiency, effectiveness, responsiveness, adaptability, flexibility, customer satisfaction, velocity, variability, visibility, variety, rework, and volume. Many of the process performance measures seek to measure the effectiveness and efficiency of the process as well as the degree to which the process goals are achieved. When deployed across the business, process performance measures can indicate the maturity level of process culture in an organization and generate a shared understanding of process performance across an organization. Performance measures are keys to defining service level agreements where an organization provides service to their customers.

Business Decisions

Business decisions are a specific kind of task or activity in a business process that determine which of a set of options will be acted upon by the process. Decisions must be made (using a task or activity) and then acted upon (often with a gateway or branch in the process). Decisions may be manual or automated, are modelled independently, and are best described using business rules. Decision rules, often implemented through a business rules engine, allow these business decisions to be automated.

Process Performance Assessment

The success of any BPM initiative rests on the intention and capability to continuously measure and monitor the performance of targeted business processes. The assessment can be static and be documented with assessment reports and scorecards, or dynamic and be delivered through dashboards. It provides necessary information to decision makers in an organization to redeploy and adjust resources in order to meet process performance goals.

11.5.3 Frameworks, Methodologies, and Techniques

.1 Frameworks

The following table lists frameworks that are commonly used within the discipline of business process management.

BPM Frameworks

Framework	Brief description
ACCORD	A methodological framework that maps current state models, as well as unstructured data, to conceptual models.
Enhanced Telecommunications Operations Map (eTOM)	A hierarchical framework developed for the telecommunications industry that has been adopted by other service-oriented industries.
Governments Strategic Reference Model (GSRM)	A life cycle framework that provides generic government processes and patterns for each stage of organizational maturity.
Model based and Integrated Process Improvement (MIPI)	A cyclical framework whose steps include assess readiness, outline process under review, detail data collection, form model of current process, assess and redesign process, implement improved process, and review process.

BPM Frameworks (Continued)

Framework	Brief description
Process Classification Framework(PCF)	A classification framework that details processes and is used for benchmarking and performance measurement.

.2 Methodologies

The following table lists methodologies that are commonly used within the discipline of business process management.

Table 11.5.1: BPM Methodologies

Methodology	Brief description
Adaptive Case Management (ACM)	A method used when processes are not fixed or static in nature, and have a lot of human interaction. An ACM process may be different each time it is performed.
Business Process Re-engineering (BPR)	The fundamental rethinking and redesigning of business processes to generate improvements in critical performance measures, such as cost, quality, service, and speed.
Continuous Improvement (CI)	The ongoing monitoring and adjustment of existing processes to bring them closer to goals or performance targets. This represents a permanent commitment of the organization to change and must be an important part of its culture.
Lean	A continuous improvement methodology that focuses on the elimination of waste in a process, defined as work for which the customer of the process will not pay.
Six Sigma	A continuous improvement methodology that focuses on the elimination of variations in the outcome of a process. It is statistically oriented and performance data centric.
Theory Of Constraints (TOC)	A methodology that holds the performance of an organization can be optimized by managing three variables: the throughput of a process, operational expense to produce that throughput, and the inventory of products. The performance of a process is dominated by one key constraint at any given time, and the process can only be optimized by improving the performance of that constraint.

Table 11.5.1: BPM Methodologies (Continued)

Methodology	Brief description
Total Quality Management (TQM)	A management philosophy that holds to the underlying principle that the processes of the organization should provide the customer and stakeholders, both internal and external, with the highest quality products and services, and that these products or services meet or exceed the customers' and stakeholders' expectations.

.3 Techniques

The following table lists techniques, not included in the Techniques chapter of the *BABOK® Guide* and are commonly used within the discipline of BPM.

Table 11.5.2: BPM Techniques

Technique	Brief Description
Cost Analysis	A list of the cost per activity totaled to show the detailed cost of the process and is used frequently by businesses to gain an understanding and appreciation of the cost associated with a product or service. Cost analysis is also known as activity based costing.
Critical to Quality (CTQ)	A set of diagrams, in the form of trees, that assist in aligning process improvement efforts to customer requirements. CTQ is a technique used in Six Sigma, but is not exclusive to Six Sigma.
Cycle-time Analysis	An analysis of the time each activity takes within the process. Cycle-time analysis is also known as a duration analysis.
Define Measure Analyze Design Verify (DMADV)	A data-driven structured roadmap used to develop new or improve existing processes. DMADV is a technique used in Six Sigma, but is not exclusive to Six Sigma.
Define Measure Analyze Improve Control (DMAIC)	A data-driven structured roadmap used to improve processes. DMAIC is a technique used in Six Sigma, but is not exclusive to Six Sigma.
Drum-Buffer-Rope (DBR)	A method used to ensure that the system constraint always functions at the maximum possible output, by ensuring that there is a sufficient buffer of materials just prior to the constraint to keep it continuously busy. It can be used in BPM to ensure process efficiency.
Failure Mode and Effect Analysis (FMEA)	A systematic method of investigating process failures and defects, and identifying potential causes. FMEA is a technique that assists in locating problems in the as-is process and correcting them when developing the to-be processes.

Table 11.5.2: BPM Techniques (Continued)

Technique	Brief Description
House of Quality/ Voice of Customer	A matrix relating customer desires and product characteristics to the capabilities of an organization. It is a technique that could be used in developing the to-be processes.
Inputs, Guide, Outputs, Enablers (IGOE)	A diagram that describes the context of a process, by listing the inputs and outputs of the process, the guides that are used to inform the execution of the process, and the supporting tools and information required for the process.
Kaizen Event	A focused, rapid effort to improve value delivery in one specific activity or sub-process.
Process Simulation	A model of the process and a set of randomized variables to allow for multiple variations of a process to be assessed and develop an estimate of their performance under actual conditions.
Suppliers Inputs Process Outputs Customers (SIPOC)	A table that summarizes inputs and outputs from multiple processes. Also known as COPIS, which is simply SIPOC spelled backwards.
Theory of Constraints (TOC) Thinking Processes	A set of logical cause-and-effect models used to diagnose conflicts, identify the root causes of problems, and define future states of a system that successfully resolve those root causes. TOC thinking processes is a technique that assists in locating problems in the as-is process and correcting them when developing the to-be processes.
Value Added Analysis	Looks at the benefit to the customer added at each step of a process to identify opportunities for improvement.
Value Stream Analysis	Used to assess the value added by each functional area of a business to the customer, as part of an end-to-end process.
Who What When Where Why (5Ws)	A set of questions that form the foundation for basic information gathering. The 5Ws may also include How added to become the 5Ws and a H.

11.5.4 Underlying Competencies

Business analysts working within the discipline of business process management are required to challenge the status quo, dig to understand the root causes of a problem, assess why things are being done in a particular way, and encourage subject matter experts (SMEs) to consider new ideas and approaches to make their processes more efficient and effective. They are also required to understand, articulate, and move back and forth between internal and external views of the processes under analysis.

Due to the effects that changes to processes have on the working habits of individuals, interaction skills are valuable in a BPM initiative. Business analysts frequently negotiate and arbitrate between individuals with different opinions, and expose and resolve conflicts between different groups within the organization. The business analyst is a neutral and independent facilitator of the change.

BPM initiatives are likely to involve all levels of the organization and the business analyst is required to communicate across organizational boundaries as well as outside the organization.

11.5.5 Impact on Knowledge Areas

This section explains how specific business analysis practices within business process management are mapped to business analysis tasks and practices as defined by the *BABOK® Guide*. This section also describes how each knowledge area is applied or modified within the business process management discipline.

Each knowledge area lists techniques relevant to a business process management perspective. *BABOK® Guide* techniques are found in the Techniques chapter of the *BABOK® Guide*. Other business analysis techniques are not found in the chapter, but are considered to be particularly useful to business analysts working in the discipline of business process management. This is not intended to be an exhaustive list of techniques but rather to highlight the types of techniques used by business analysts while performing the tasks within the knowledge area.

.1 Business Analysis Planning and Monitoring

Progressive elaboration is common in the planning of BPM initiatives due to the fact that the amount of information available for full planning may be limited in the initial stages. BPM initiatives involve continuous improvement activities, and a common cause of failure of BPM initiatives is the failure to plan for ongoing monitoring of the effect of changes to the process. In BPM initiatives, the initial focus of business analysis work is on analyzing and improving the business process before looking at the technology used to support the process, and any changes that might be required to software applications or work procedures.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Estimation (p. 271)
- Item Tracking (p. 294)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Reviews (p. 326)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Inputs, Guide, Outputs, Enablers (IGOE)

.2 Elicitation and Collaboration

For the BPM initiative to be successful, the scope of the initiative and the scope of the affected process must be defined and understood.

Process modelling and stakeholder analysis are generally utilized during the elicitation phase of a BPM initiative. During elicitation, the business analyst focuses on cause and effect of both changing existing processes and keeping the processes as they are through the elicitation and collaboration effort. As an existing process is changed, the effect of any process improvements identified on the organization, people, and technology are considered. Process maps are an important tool to drive elicitation in BPM initiatives and stakeholders are frequently consulted during their development. Effective elicitation and collaboration is critical in process modelling analysis and design work.

Process changes can have significant impacts across the organization, so managing stakeholders and their expectations is particularly critical. Without effective stakeholder management, process changes may not be successfully implemented or the changes may not meet the organization's goals and objectives.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Document Analysis (p. 269)
- Focus Groups (p. 279)
- Interface Analysis (p. 287)
- Interviews (p. 290)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Observation (p. 305)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Prototyping (p. 323)
- Reviews (p. 326)
- Root Cause Analysis (p. 335)
- Scope Modelling (p. 338)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- Use Cases and Scenarios (p. 356)
- User Stories (p. 359)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- House of Quality/Voice of Customer

.3 Requirements Life Cycle Management

BPM is a set of approaches that focus on ways to deliver value across multiple functional areas through a process-centric lens. Delivering additional value is often related to deliberately undertaking change but could also result from an ad hoc request or review of processes. The impact of BPM activities on requirements life cycle management is significant as it can drive out business requirements resulting in new design, coding, implementation, and post-implementation changes. It is the responsibility of the business analyst to maintain this connection and ensure that communication is effectively conducted with stakeholders and process owners who are the ultimate decision makers when it is about processes, change, and supporting solutions.

The documentation of business processes is available to all stakeholders as it is to be used in the daily operation of the business. If the process is automated through a BPMS, the representation of the process may be directly executable.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Acceptance and Evaluation Criteria (p. 217)
- Backlog Management (p. 220)
- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Business Rules Analysis (p. 240)
- Non-Functional Requirements Analysis (p. 302)
- Prioritization (p. 311)
- Process Analysis (p. 314)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Prototyping (p. 323)
- Scope Modelling (p. 338)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- none

.4 Strategy Analysis

In a BPM context, strategy analysis involves understanding the role the process plays in an enterprise value chain. At a minimum, any process that interacts with the processes affected by the initiative must be considered.

The current state is likely to be described by the as-is value chain and the current performance measures for the business process. The future state will be described by the to-be value chain and target performance measures. Continuous improvement methods may simply focus on the performance measures to determine the strategy. The change strategy will involve the identification of possible process changes.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Document Analysis (p. 269)
- Functional Decomposition (p. 283)
- Interviews (p. 290)
- Lessons Learned (p. 296)
- Process Analysis (p. 314)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Drum-Buffer-Rope
- House of Quality/Voice of Customer
- Inputs, Guide, Outputs, Enablers (IGOE)
- TOC Thinking Processes

.5 Requirements Analysis and Design Definition

Requirements analysis and design definition will focus on defining the to-be process model. The requirements architecture is likely to include the process model, associated business rules and decisions, information requirements, and the organizational structure. Solution options typically include changes to IT needed to support the process, outsourcing of aspects of the process, and similar changes.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Benchmarking and Market Analysis (p. 226)
- Business Rules Analysis (p. 240)
- Decision Modelling (p. 265)
- Estimation (p. 271)
- Functional Decomposition (p. 283)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Prioritization (p. 311)
- Prototyping (p. 323)
- Scope Modelling (p. 338)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Workshops (p. 363)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Kaizen Event
- Process Simulation

.6 Solution Evaluation

Solution evaluation typically occurs repeatedly during BPM initiatives in order to assess the performance of the business process. As processes are evaluated for different scenarios, they can be refined and the results are monitored. Solution evaluation tasks provide insight into the understanding of the impact of process improvements and the value delivered by business process change. The solution may also involve process mining which uses such techniques as audit trails or transaction logs to obtain process details.

The analyze solution performance task is performed to understand the differences between potential value and actual value. This analysis is performed to discover why there is a variance between potential and actual value, to determine if a solution can perform better or realize more value. The evaluation examines opportunities or constraints of the implemented solution, how it satisfies needs, or how it could be improved. This may trigger further optimization of the process and a repeat of the BPM life cycle.

BABOK® Guide Techniques

- Acceptance and Evaluation Criteria (p. 217)
- Balanced Scorecard (p. 223)
- Benchmarking and Market Analysis (p. 226)
- Brainstorming (p. 227)
- Business Capability Analysis (p. 230)
- Business Rules Analysis (p. 240)
- Decision Analysis (p. 261)
- Document Analysis (p. 269)
- Estimation (p. 271)
- Interviews (p. 290)
- Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) (p. 297)
- Observation (p. 305)
- Organizational Modelling (p. 308)
- Process Modelling (p. 318)
- Reviews (p. 326)
- Risk Analysis and Management (p. 329)
- Root Cause Analysis (p. 335)
- Stakeholder List, Map, or Personas (p. 344)
- Survey or Questionnaire (p. 350)
- SWOT Analysis (p. 353)

Other Business Analysis Techniques

- Kaizen Event
- Failure Mode and Effect Analysis (FMEA)
- Process Simulation
- Value Stream Analysis